

Beginner guitar practice sheet

One worked 15-minute session. Standard tuning (E A D G B e). Start every block slower than feels necessary.

1. One string, four fingers

3 min

Play: frets 1-2-3-4 on the low E string, one finger per fret, then back down. Riff Quest exercise: **Spider — One String**.

Goal: every note rings clean, including the little finger.

Start by: setting a slow click and playing one note per beat.

Needs attention:

2. One chord change: Em to Am

4 min

Play: four slow strums of Em, four of Am, and repeat. **Own drill — not an app exercise:** do this away from the screen, with a clock.

Goal: the change happens without the strumming hand stopping.

Start by: making the shape in the air three times before you play anything.

Needs attention:

3. Steady rhythm: down-up strumming

4 min

Play: down on the beat, up on the "and", on one chord. Riff Quest exercise: **Strumming — Down-Up**.

Goal: the hand keeps swinging even through a missed strum.

Start by: strumming with no chord at all, just muted strings, until the pendulum is even.

Needs attention:

4. Put it together

4 min

Play: Em – Em – Am – Am, one bar each, with the down-up pattern from block 3, round and round. **Own drill — not an app exercise.**

Goal: four times round without stopping, at any tempo.

Start by: playing it at half the speed you think you can manage.

Needs attention:

3 + 4 + 4 + 4 = 15 minutes.

From **Riff Quest** — <https://riff.quest/beginner-guitar-exercises>

Interactive tabs for blocks 1 and 3:

<https://riff.quest/beginner-guitar-exercises#spider-one-string>

<https://riff.quest/beginner-guitar-exercises#strumming-down-up>

Weekly practice sheet

Blank and reusable. Print one a week. Minutes and tempo are yours to write in — nothing on paper counts anything for you.

Date	Exercise	Minutes	Tempo	Notes

Week in one line

From **Riff Quest** — <https://riff.quest/beginner-guitar-exercises>

To keep the same record digitally, a free Riff Quest account logs a session at <https://riff.quest/report> and reads it back at <https://riff.quest/practice-log>. Nothing on this sheet is imported for you.